CURRICULUM VITAE

PERSONAL INFORMATION

Full Name: Blaise Binama
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Nationality: Rwandan
Current Residence: Rudold-Winkel-Str.12, 37079 Goettingen, Germany

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EDUCATION

PhD in Natural Sciences (Dr. rer. nat.). 2019–2023, University of Bielefeld, Faculty of Biology
MSc in Biodiversity and Collection Management. 2016–2018, Technische Universität Dresden/IHI Zittau, Germany
BSc in Biology/Botany and Conservation. 2012–2016, University of Rwanda

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WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant: April 2024 - Georg-August-University Göttingen, Faculty of Agricultural Sciences
Research: Influence of environmental variables in agricultural system.
Project: CONSERWA

Research fellow: September 2019- Center of Excellence for Biodiversity and Natural Resource Management, University of Rwanda

Research Assistant: July 2019-March 2023 University of Bielefeld, Germany
Teaching: Plant defense mechanisms, invasive plant biology, R programming
Supervised project modules and bachelor's students

Individual Consultant: Nov-Dec 2022 UNESCO World Heritage Centre
Reviewed and drafting nomination dossiers for the Gola-Tiwai Complex, Sierra Leone.

Individual Consultant: 09.2024-03.2025
IUCN technical field evaluation mission to a natural World Heritage site in Lao PDR and deliver field evaluation report to the IUCN World Heritage Panel.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Plant ecology and interactions with (a)biotic factors
Biodiversity conservation and climate change impact

KEY PUBLICATIONS

1. **Binama, B., and Caroline Müller (2024)**. Differences in growth and competition between plants of a naturalised and invasive population of Bunias orientalis. Ecology and Evolution, 14, e11153. DOI
2. **Binama, B.**, and Caroline Müller. Differences in functional traits among distinct populations of the plant invader Bunias orientalis. Journal of Plant Ecology, 15 (3), 524–537 (2022). DOI
3. **Binama, B.**, Behrendt, M., & Müller, C. The responses of Bunias orientalis to short-term fungal infection and insect herbivory are independent of nutrient supply. Journal of Chemical Ecology, 48, 827–840 (2022). DOI
4. **Binama, B**. (2016). Ficus species distribution within the home range of chimpanzees in Nyungwe National Park, Rwanda. Unpublished Data

5. **Binama, B**., Ntawubizigira, E., Tuyisabe, A. In Prep. Machine learning reveals patterns and drivers of invasive plant establishment in the Gishwati Mukura Biosphere Reserve
6. Buschmann, S., Tushabe, D., **Binama, B**., Herklotz, V., Neinhuis, Olbricht, K., and Ritz, C. In Prep. Genetic diversity in European native strawberries and the origin of spontaneous hybrids
7. **Binama, B**., Kaplin, B.A. In Prep. Restoring forest health under climate change: A remote sensing approach to tree vulnerability in Eastern Rwanda

CONFERENCE PAPER

1. **Binama, B**., and Dushimimana, F. Redefining ecological integrity for dynamic ecosystems: Insights from Nyungwe National Park, Rwanda. International Conference on Heritage Authenticity and Integrity in Africa

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GRANTS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

2024: UNESCO Man and Biosphere Programme - Young Scientist Research Award ($5,000)
Research: Understanding and managing invasive plants in forest restoration
2024: Georg-August-Universität Göttingen Young Scientist Award
Project: Developing predictive models for genetic-environment interactions
2022: German Botanical Society: International conference of the German Botanical Society, 28 August -1 September 2022, 400 euros
2016–2018: Master's Scholarship funded by the Dietmar-Schmid-Foundation
2015: World Wildlife Fund-Rwanda Environmental Management Authority: Sustainable solid waste management at the University of Rwanda, Huye Campus, November 2015-January 2016, 5000 $.

CERTIFICATES AND ACHIEVEMENTS2023:

2024: Youth jury for the International Association of Horticultural Producers (AIPH) World Green City Award 2024
2023: Hyperspectral data for land and coastal systems organised by ARSET and NASA
2016: Certificate of completion of the MaxEnt training organised by RNCEAR in partnership with CoEB
2015: Certificate of completion of the introductory training in remote sensing for conservation and tropical forest monitoring using CLASlite organised by RNCEAR

COMPUTER SKILLS

Data Analysis: R programming, SPSS, MaxEnt
Geospatial Tools: ArcGIS, Remote Sensing
Laboratory Tools: GCMS analysis, Chromeleon 7 (HPLC), CN Analyzer

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REFERENCES

Prof. Dr. Stefan Scholten, Georg-August-University Göttingen
Email: stefan.scholten@uni-goettingen.de
Prof. Dr. Caroline Müller, University of Bielefeld
Email: caroline.mueller@uni-bielefeld.de
Prof. Dr. Beth Kaplin, University of Rwanda
Email: bkaplin@antioch.edu
